PRIYA RAGHAVAN

Senior Backend Engineer
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend engineer with 7 years building and operating distributed systems in Python and Go. Led the decomposition of a payments monolith into eleven services handling 40M requests/day at p99 under 120ms. Comfortable owning a system end to end: schema design, service code, deployment pipeline, on-call rotation and the postmortem afterwards. Particular interest in the reliability and security of data pipelines.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Distributed Systems | Event-Driven Architecture | API Design | Observability
Database Performance | Incident Response | Mentoring | Technical Writing

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Go, SQL, TypeScript, Bash
Frameworks: FastAPI, Django, gRPC, Celery, React
Data: PostgreSQL, Redis, Kafka, ClickHouse, Elasticsearch
Infrastructure: AWS (EC2, RDS, S3, Lambda), Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform
Practice: GitHub Actions, Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry, pytest

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Backend Engineer, Meridian Payments 2022 - present
Bengaluru, India

- Led migration of a payments monolith to eleven event-driven services, cutting p99 latency from 480ms to 115ms while traffic grew 3x.
- Designed the idempotency layer that eliminated duplicate settlement events; reconciliation discrepancies fell from ~40/week to zero.
- Introduced contract testing between services, reducing integration failures caught in staging by 70% over two quarters.
- Owned the on-call rotation for four services; cut paging volume 55% by fixing alert thresholds rather than adding dashboards.
- Mentored three junior engineers, two of whom now lead their own services.

Backend Engineer, Latitude Analytics 2020 - 2022
Remote

- Built the ingestion pipeline processing 2TB/day of clickstream data into ClickHouse, replacing a batch job that ran six hours behind.
- Cut warehouse spend 38% by restructuring partitioning and dropping three redundant materialised views.
- Added request tracing across seven services, turning multi-day latency investigations into same-day ones.

Software Engineer, Northwind Systems 2018 - 2020
Pune, India

- Shipped REST APIs in Django serving 1.2M daily active users.
- Reduced a nightly reporting job from 4 hours to 18 minutes by replacing row-by-row processing with set-based SQL.
- Wrote the onboarding guide still used by the platform team.

SELECTED PROJECTS

pgwatch - open source (1.2k stars)

- PostgreSQL query analyser that flags N+1 patterns from pg_stat_statements. Python, asyncio, Grafana dashboards.

Kafka consumer lag exporter

- Prometheus exporter adopted internally across 30+ consumer groups; surfaced a rebalancing bug that had gone unnoticed for months.

Schema migration linter

- CI check that rejects migrations taking a table lock longer than 50ms. Prevented three would-be production outages in its first quarter.

EDUCATION

B.Tech, Computer Science and Engineering 2014 - 2018
National Institute of Technology | CGPA 8.6/10

- Coursework: Distributed Systems, Database Internals, Cryptography, Compilers.

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate (2023)
- Certified Kubernetes Application Developer, CNCF (2022)

PUBLICATIONS AND TALKS

- "Idempotency Without Tears" - PyCon India, 2024.
- "What We Learned Decomposing a Payments Monolith" - company engineering blog, 2023.

AWARDS

- Engineering Excellence Award, Meridian Payments (2023).
- Runner-up, National Hackathon on Financial Infrastructure (2019).